

**Fitbit Ionic**

After a long rumored release, the Fitbit smartwatch is finally here and it's called the Ionic.
<http://dgit.in/FitIonic>

**RIP Alloy**

Intel won't be releasing its Project Alloy VR headset platform due to lack of partner interest.
<http://dgit.in/DeadAlloy>

About the **R****G****B** madness

It's high time we weighed in on the RGB madness that's plaguing the industry

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A

lot has been said about the RGB infestation that has nearly eaten up the PC components

industry. Every component and even sub-component now comes with RGB. Heck, if the laws of electronics didn't apply, they'd even pack RGB LEDs onto SMT resistors and capacitors just because they could. That being said, is RGB truly bad for you? Is it the cancerous rot that'll slowly fester and kill the host? The answer isn't a simple yes or no.

ISN'T THIS AN OLD DEBATE?

Yes, and we'll tell you why we're digging an old grave. A couple of days back, an acquaintance of mine who works in the industry was pining over the current state of the market. The company he works for tries to focus on quality components rather than going in for flash. Apparently, our fascination for tacky RGB LEDs has led to a manufacturer driven drive towards more RGB ready products. And that's a worrying trend. When aesthetics creeps up on the list of priorities while designing a product, manufacturers are forced to make a call. Sure, you can always have hero products with all the bells and whistles, except hero products only sell so little that a company can't solely focus on them.

When designing a product, the company has a certain cost in mind.



G.Skill TridentZ RGB Kit

Every competitor is targeting the same price bracket, so competition is intense and you need to make a call. Either you include RGB LEDs or you opt for better quality components for the existing features. A good example would be when a motherboard company is forced to pick between capacitors of low-ESR value with no RGB lighting versus capacitors with moderate-ESR values and use the money saved for including RGB lighting. In case you didn't find that example as lucid as we thought it out to be, then the former option is better for you, the consumer, from a longevity and stability perspective.

Here's the kicker, we haven't seen a board where the quality of passive components were compromised upon for the sake of including RGB. The caveat here is that we are sent motherboards which are either top-of-the-line or have some unique addition. RGB is often present in the higher end boards while those with mid or low-end chipsets tend to not have it. However, the need to have more RGB has resulted in even the mid-range boards getting it. The differentiating factor is that the higher-end boards have access to features like synchronisation and more customisable lighting patterns.